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AI vs the Sky: same week, two lenses

- Market: WTI crude oil, Cushing, Oklahoma spot price (US$ per barrel), daily.
- Week shown: Monday 19 October to Friday 23 October 2026.

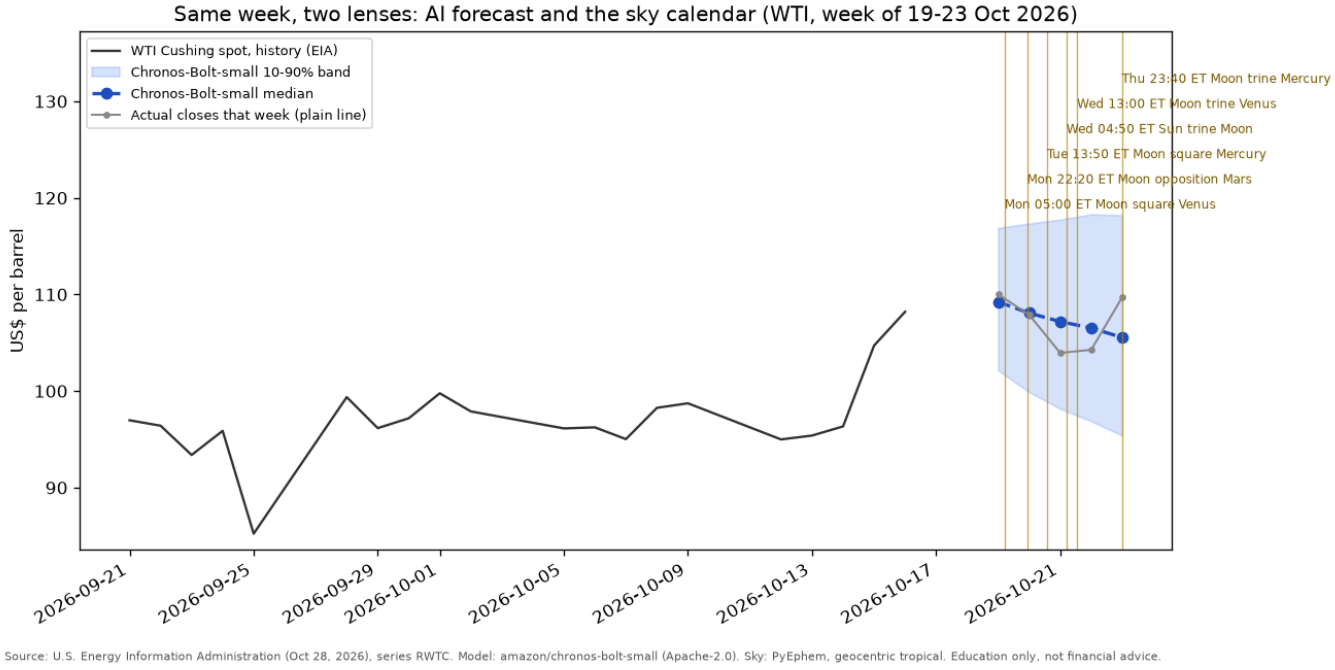
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What this is

We took one past week of the oil price and looked at it through two lenses at once.

1. **The AI lens.** A free, open forecasting model looked only at the prices before that week and drew what it thought the week might look like. It gives a middle line and a shaded band. The band is the model saying "I'm not sure, and here's how unsure I am."
2. **The sky lens.** A plain planetary calendar for the same five days: the Moon's phase and sign, where Mercury was, and the exact planetary angles that formed that week.

Neither lens is a signal. Neither one is scored here and neither one "wins". The point is to learn how to read a forecast band and a sky calendar side by side, calmly, before the week starts.



The AI lens: what the model drew

The model saw prices up to Friday 16 October (last close $108.21) and drew this for the following week.

Day	Low end of band (10%)	Middle line	High end of band (90%)
Mon 19 Oct	$102.13	$109.24	$116.90
Tue 20 Oct	$99.89	$108.07	$117.34
Wed 21 Oct	$98.18	$107.19	$117.75
Thu 22 Oct	$96.87	$106.52	$118.30
Fri 23 Oct	$95.39	$105.54	$118.21

How to read it: notice how the band gets wider each day. The further ahead a forecast looks, the less it knows. A wide band is honesty, not weakness.

For reference, the actual closes that week were $110.01, $107.89, $103.95, $104.27 and $109.72 (Monday to Friday). They're drawn as a plain grey line on the chart.

The sky lens: the planetary calendar

Daily snapshot, taken at 12:00 noon New York time.

Day	Moon phase (lit)	Moon sign	Mercury sign	Mercury direction
Mon 19 Oct	First Quarter (60%)	Aquarius	Scorpio	Direct, slowing
Tue 20 Oct	Waxing Gibbous (69%)	Aquarius	Scorpio	Direct, slowing
Wed 21 Oct	Waxing Gibbous (78%)	Pisces	Scorpio	Direct, slowing
Thu 22 Oct	Waxing Gibbous (86%)	Pisces	Scorpio	Direct, slowing
Fri 23 Oct	Waxing Gibbous (92%)	Pisces	Scorpio	Direct, nearly still

Mercury was slowing all week. It stood still and turned retrograde on Saturday 24 October at about 04:00 New York time (around 21 degrees Scorpio), the day after this week ended. It turns direct again on Friday 13 November.

Exact angles that week (Sun, Moon, Mercury, Venus and Mars; conjunction, square, trine and opposition, within 1 degree). Times are New York time.

When	Event
Mon 19 Oct, 05:00	Moon square Venus
Mon 19 Oct, 22:20	Moon opposite Mars (closest point, within 0.1 degree)
Tue 20 Oct, 13:50	Moon square Mercury
Wed 21 Oct, 04:50	Sun trine Moon

When	Event
Wed 21 Oct, 13:00	Moon trine Venus
Thu 22 Oct, 23:40	Moon trine Mercury

All six angles that week involve the fast-moving Moon. None of the slower planets formed an exact angle with each other during these five days. The angles are the gold vertical lines on the chart.

Why neither one is a signal

- The AI band is a range of possibilities, not a promise. Prices can and do leave the band.
- The sky calendar marks the timing of events in the sky. It says nothing on its own about which way a price moves.
- Putting them side by side shows two very different ways of thinking about one week. That's all it shows.

Method note

- **Data:** U.S. Energy Information Administration (EIA), "Cushing, OK WTI Spot Price FOB (Dollars per Barrel)", daily, series RWTC. Downloaded on 2026-10-31 from https://www.eia.gov/dnav/pet/hist_xls/RWTCd.xls (series page: https://www.eia.gov/dnav/pet/hist/rwtcD.htm). EIA file release date 28 Oct 2026; latest data 27 Oct 2026.
- **Data terms:** EIA's Copyrights and Reuse page (https://www.eia.gov/about/copyrights_reuse.php), under "Public domain and use of EIA content", says: "U.S. government publications are in the public domain and are not subject to copyright protection. You may use and/or distribute any of our data, files, databases, reports, graphs, charts, and other information products that are on our website or that you receive through our email distribution service. However, if you use or reproduce any of our information products, you should use an acknowledgment, which includes the publication date, such as: "Source: U.S. Energy Information Administration (Oct 2008)."".
- **Acknowledgment used:** Source: U.S. Energy Information Administration (Oct 28, 2026).
- **Model:** amazon/chronos-bolt-small from Hugging Face (Apache-2.0 license; model revision 772f3d25), run with the open chronos-forecasting package version 2.3.2 on our own computer, on CPU. No data was sent anywhere.
- **Context:** the model saw the 2,048 daily prices before the week (7 Aug 2018 to 16 Oct 2026) and nothing after. It forecast 5 trading days and we show the 10%, 50% (middle) and 90% levels.
- **Sky calendar:** PyEphem version 4.2.1. Geocentric (as seen from Earth), tropical zodiac (ecliptic of date), apparent positions. Daily snapshots at 12:00 New York time. Exact angles were found by checking every 10 minutes across the week.
- **No scoring:** we don't measure, score or rank either lens, and this piece makes no accuracy claims.

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Source: U.S. Energy Information Administration (Oct 28, 2026). Daily WTI Cushing spot price, series RWTC, public domain.

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